Sitting Coding

Sitting behavior is coded using DataVyu from in-home videos. All videos should have a side view of the baby and each sitting video should last about 60 seconds. Use this manual to code the sitting trials correctly and accurately.

Coding start and end

Start of trial: When experimenter is hidden from view (experimenter camera is black), child is seated on the ground, and parent lets go of the child for the first time. You may also listen for experimenter comments such as "are you ready? Ok, go!"

End of trial: After 60 seconds of coding duration have passed. Please estimate this based on your start time. For example, if your start time was 2.33 seconds, coding should end at 62.33 seconds.

Important: Make sure the last offset is the final coding value (and the largest number)

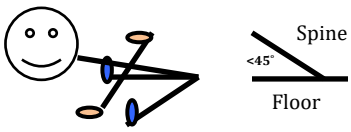
Definitions:

(0)Supported:

Child **is sitting** and being supported by the parent. The parent may touch either the hip, belly, shoulders, or back of the child to provide support. Use this category if either hand of the parent is touching the child. Use your best judgment on whether the parent is supporting the child's weight or not, if not, it should not be coded as supported.
Remember – the child is SITTING here. If the child has lost balance, is flat on their tummy or side, it should be coded as "falling".
NOTE: Most parents will keep their hands close to the child in preparation to catch the child. Use the live video to make sure a parent is indeed supporting the child and not just having the hands close without support. During the study, parents were instructed to let go of their child.

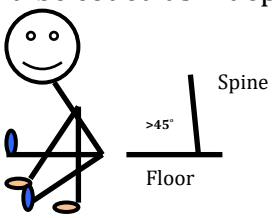
(1)Flat (Pike):

Child is bends forward with an angle between spine and floor of less then 45 degrees. Child may or may not use arms for support.



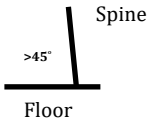
(2)Tripod:

The child is sitting with their spine at an angle greater than 45 degrees to the floor, there is no parent support, and the child is using either or both hands for stability by placing the hand on the **FLOOR**. The hand has to be on the floor, putting the hand on another body part (e.g., knee, feet) is not considered tripod sitting but should be coded as independent sitting.



(3)Independent Sitting:

Child has no hands on the ground with angle between spine and floor of more than 45 degrees (in rare cases, could be lower than 45 degrees but demonstrates independent sitting abilities). Parent is not supporting child. Child may be unstable and sway. Child may place hands on other body parts such as legs or feet.



(F)Falling: Child has lost balance and is falling over. Start coding Falling once the child starts to fall and keep this category checked while the **child is on his/her tummy or being lifted** by the parent. This code ends at the moment the child is being put back into the sitting position (butt touching the floor).
Note: This should be a short duration, but do keep it checked in case the parent and child spend a long time before they get back into a sitting position.

(N) Not able to code: Use this code when the child is not given an opportunity to sit, or the baby is out of frame. Examples include: The parent holds the baby in their arms or puts the baby on the back on the floor, or the baby crawls away and is not visible in the video.

Final note: **These codes are mutually exclusive and one code should be checked at all times. There should never (ever) be a period in the video where no code is selected. Please make 100% certain of this.**

Sitter Classification:

Calculating postural time All percentages are calculated as a proportion of total codable postural time, defined as the sum of time in postures 0, 1, 2, and 3. Time coded as falling (F) or unobserved/uncodable (N) is excluded from the denominator, as neither represents a stable postural state.

Sitter The infant is classified as an independent sitter if independent sitting (posture 3) accounts for ≥ 50% of codable postural time.

Emergent sitter The infant is classified as an emergent sitter if the combined time in tripod sitting (posture 2) and independent sitting (posture 3) accounts for ≥ 50% of codable postural time, but independent sitting (posture 3) alone accounts for < 50% of codable postural time.

Non-sitter The infant is classified as a non-sitter if the combined time in supported sitting (posture 0) and floor-based postures (posture 1) accounts for ≥ 50% of codable postural time.

Classification priority Categories are applied in the order listed above. An infant is assigned to the first category whose criteria they meet, ensuring mutual exclusivity across all cases.